

when "he heard that there was a festival in Babylon, in which all the Babylonians drank and revelled the whole night." The attacking party was headed by Cyrus, with his officers Gadatas and Gobryas acting as guides. They entered the city, taking advantage of the revelry in the streets, and easily reached the palace. They entered and found the king standing with his sword drawn; he was made away with by Gadatas and Gobryas and their party, and then ensued a massacre of those found in the streets. Soon after Cyrus held a public reception and entered into the palace.

Certain parallels with the story in Dan. 5 are obvious and interesting, and the reconstruction often made is that this unnamed king of the *Cyropaedia* is Belshazzar, that he was functioning as king, even without the actual name, and that Gobryas who killed him is Darius the Mede, the Gubaru of the Bab. records.

On these stories it is to be remarked that historians now universally reject the tradition of a forcible capture of Babylon in view of the plain record of the Nabonidus-Cyrus Chronicle that Cyrus' troops under Gubaru peacefully occupied the city and captured Nabonidus in it, he himself celebrating his triumph a little later. Furthermore we have the account of Berossus preserved by Josephus, *C. Apionem*, i, 20, which varies somewhat from the official records but gives no room for a 'king Belshazzar.' We read: "When Nabonnedus perceived that Cyrus was coming to attack him, he met him with his forces, and, joining battle with him, was beaten and fled away with a few of his troops, and was shut up within the city Borsippa. Hereupon Cyrus took Babylon and gave order that the outer walls of the city should be demolished, because the city had proved very troublesome to him, and cost him great pains to take it. He then marched away to Borsippa to besiege Nabonnedus; but as Nabonnedus did not sustain the siege, but delivered himself into his hands, he was at first kindly treated by Cyrus, who gave him Carmania as a place for him to inhabit and sent him out of Babylonia." It is to be noticed that there are variations from the Chronicle, especially in regard to the resistance put up by Nabonidus and the difficulty of taking the city promptly. It must be borne in mind that Berossus himself is a witness 240 years after the events he narrates, although withal a much